

The Human-AI Partnership Framework

Where human judgment belongs

Relationship-to-Service

PCF 8.1 — Understand needs & manage service levels — Value Stream Profile

This value stream comprises one APQC PCF process group: 8.1 Develop and Manage IT Customer Relationships — spanning 7 Level 3 processes and 36 Level 4 activities.

At the activity level, this value stream's work breaks down as 23 Knowledge activities (judgment, synthesis, and interpretation-driven work), 6 Transaction activities (rules-based processing suited to automation), 3 Decision activities (judgment-and-authority gates that stay human by design), 3 Document activities (content generation), and 1 Exception activity (non-standard resolution).

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), the value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 60%, down from an 81% undesigned baseline — a 21-point AI convergence opportunity.

L3 PROCESSES	L4 ACTIVITIES	M1 BASELINE H%	M3 DESIGN INTENT H%	Δ M1 → M3
7	36	81%	60%	-21%

KPIs

Business Impact Metric & Formula (where confirmed)	Source
Cost-to-serve <i>Total cost to perform “develop and manage IT customer relationships” (incl. depreciation/amortization) ÷ (Total business entity revenue × 0.001)</i>	APQC OSB
SLA Compliance Ratio <i>Service requests/incidents resolved within agreed SLA targets ÷ total requests/incidents</i>	ITIL
IT customer satisfaction (CSAT) <i>No single standardized formula — measured as weighted average of favorable survey responses following IT service interactions, per cycle</i>	ITIL

Design Narrative

Relationship-to-Service concentrates ownership more tightly than its former combined form: IT Service Manager holds Accountable for 5 of the stream's 7 L3s — understanding customer needs (8.1.1), service planning and communication (8.1.3), service-level definition (8.1.5), ongoing relationship management (8.1.6), and performance analysis (8.1.7) — the day-to-day ITSM lane this stream is built around. IT Director holds the two remaining L3s, both explicitly transformation-facing rather than operational: identifying IT customer transformation needs (8.1.2) and providing transformation guidance (8.1.4), where Enterprise Architect and CIO appear only as Consulted, never Accountable. Human judgment concentrates in negotiation and prioritization — SLA negotiation (8.1.5.6) and IT-opportunity prioritization (8.1.4.4, 8.1.4.6) are the stream's three Decision-pattern activities. Its steepest AI-absorption opportunity sits in 8.1.3.4 (Create IT marketing messages, Document-pattern, -32 points).

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across this value stream's activity units. H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

Decision <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 3 L4 activities M1 92% → M3 80%	Knowledge <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 23 L4 activities M1 85% → M3 65%	Document <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 3 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	Transaction <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 6 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%	Exception <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 1 L4 activities M1 95% → M3 82%
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Process Accountability

Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
IT Service Manager	Managerial	8.1.1, 8.1.3, 8.1.5, 8.1.6, 8.1.7	23
IT Director	Managerial	8.1.2, 8.1.4	13

Handoff Points

The stream opens with IT Service Manager on understanding customer needs (8.1.1) and service planning/communication (8.1.3), then briefly hands to IT Director for the two transformation-facing L3s (8.1.2 transformation needs, 8.1.4 transformation guidance) before returning to IT Service Manager.

IT Service Manager closes the stream: service-level definition and negotiation (8.1.5), ongoing relationship management (8.1.6), and performance analysis (8.1.7) — the stream's largest single lane.

IT Support Specialist appears at both ends as Responsible (8.1.1 needs assessment, 8.1.7 performance analysis) without ever holding Accountable — a data-gathering and execution role bookending IT Service Manager's ownership.

Governed Decision Points

Every Decision/Exception-pattern activity in the value stream, including those embedded inside Mixed-labeled steps.

PCF	Decision	Authority	Impact	Escalates To	Trigger
8.1.4.4	Identify and prioritize IT opportunities	IT Director	Strategic — shapes future IT investment direction	CIO (Executive)	Opportunity requires cross-functional resource commitment beyond IT Director's standing authority
8.1.4.6	Prioritize IT outcomes	IT Director	Strategic	CIO (Executive)	Outcome prioritization conflicts with previously committed transformation roadmap
8.1.5.6	Negotiate and establish service level agreements	IT Service Manager	Operational + Financial — defines service commitments and resourcing implications	IT Director (Managerial)	SLA terms require resourcing beyond currently approved service capacity
8.1.7.2	Triage SLA compliance issues	IT Service Manager	Operational + Reputational	IT Director (Managerial)	Compliance issue affects a business-critical service or recurs across multiple SLA periods